

Cold Email Templates for E-commerce Brands

Proven Outreach Templates to Win Wholesale Accounts, Secure Partnerships, and Scale Revenue

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How to Use This Template Pack

This pack contains 10 cold email templates crafted for e-commerce brands, DTC companies, and online retailers. Whether you are pitching wholesale accounts, proposing influencer collaborations, reaching out to retail buyers, or re-engaging customers who abandoned their first order, these templates are built to generate revenue.

E-commerce outreach is different from traditional B2B because the sales cycle is often shorter, visual proof matters enormously, and margins dictate everything. These templates are written with that reality in mind -- they lead with product-market fit, social proof, and clear commercial terms.

Each template includes a subject line, full email body, and a revenue-focused call to action.

- Replace all bracketed placeholders [like this] with your product details, pricing, and brand specifics
- Optimal send times for retail buyers: Tuesday-Wednesday 9-11am. For influencers: Thursday-Friday 11am-2pm
- Include product images or a lookbook link whenever possible -- e-commerce is visual
- Wait 4-5 business days between follow-ups to retail and wholesale prospects
- Personalise by referencing the recipient's store, social feed, or recent product launches
- Always include clear commercial terms (margins, MOQs, shipping) in wholesale outreach

Template 1: Initial Outreach -- Wholesale Retail Buyer

SUBJECT LINE: [Product Category] that sells out in [Timeframe] -- wholesale enquiry

Hi [First Name],

I am [Your Name], founder of [Brand Name]. I have been following [Store Name] for a while and love how you curate your [product category -- e.g., homeware / skincare / accessories] collection. Your selection of [specific brand they stock] tells me we share similar taste and values.

I wanted to introduce [Brand Name] as a potential addition to your shelves. We make [one-sentence product description -- e.g., hand-poured soy candles using 100% natural fragrances, designed and produced in the UK].

Here is why I think we would sell well in [Store Name]:

- Our best-selling [Product] has a 94% repeat purchase rate across our DTC channel
- Average retail margin: [X]% at our suggested wholesale pricing
- We have been featured in [Press Mention 1], [Press Mention 2], and [Press Mention 3]
- Our products are currently stocked in [Number] independent retailers with an average reorder rate of [X] per quarter

I would love to send you a sample box at our cost so you can experience the quality firsthand. No minimum order for your first purchase.

CTA: Interested in samples? Reply with your delivery address and I will have them shipped this week. Or view our full wholesale catalogue here: [Link]

WHY THIS WORKS: Retail buyers receive hundreds of wholesale pitches. This template stands out by leading with sell-through data and commercial terms rather than just product descriptions.

1. Research the store's existing product range and reference a specific brand or product they carry
2. Include repeat purchase rate and retail margin figures -- these are the numbers buyers care about most
3. Offering free samples with no minimum order removes all risk from the buyer's first commitment

Template 2: Initial Outreach -- Influencer Collaboration

SUBJECT LINE: Collab idea for [Influencer Name] x [Brand Name]

Hi [First Name],

I have been following your content for [timeframe] and genuinely love [specific content reference -- e.g., your recent series on sustainable fashion / your honest product reviews / your minimalist home tours]. Your audience's engagement is incredible, and the way you [specific observation] really sets you apart.

I am the [Role] at [Brand Name], and I think there is a natural fit for a collaboration. We make [product description], and our brand values -- [value 1], [value 2], [value 3] -- align closely with the content you create.

Here is what I had in mind:

- We send you our [Product/Collection] to try (gift, no strings attached, no obligation to post)
- If you love it, we would be thrilled to sponsor a dedicated [post/video/story series] with full creative control on your end
- Compensation: [Specific offer -- e.g., Product gift + flat fee of [Amount] + [X]% commission on sales through your unique link / OR product gift + affiliate commission structure]

I believe in letting the product speak for itself. If it does not genuinely resonate with you and your audience, I would rather know that than have a forced partnership.

CTA: Open to receiving a sample? Reply with your preferred shipping address. Or if you would like to discuss terms first, I am happy to hop on a quick call.

WHY THIS WORKS: Influencers receive dozens of generic collaboration requests daily. Specific references to their content prove you are a genuine follower, and offering a no-obligation product gift respects their autonomy.

1. Watch or read at least 3-5 pieces of their content before reaching out -- reference something specific
2. Always offer a no-strings gift first, separate from the paid collaboration proposal
3. Giving full creative control significantly increases the likelihood of an enthusiastic, authentic partnership

Template 3: Initial Outreach -- Brand Partnership or Cross-Promotion

SUBJECT LINE: [Brand Name] x [Their Brand] -- a partnership that makes sense

Hi [First Name],

I am [Your Name] from [Brand Name]. We make [product description], and our customers look a lot like yours -- [describe shared audience -- e.g., health-conscious millennials who value quality over quantity / homeowners aged 30-50 who invest in premium products].

I have been thinking about a cross-promotion that could benefit both of us without cannibalising each other's sales:

- Option A: Bundle deal -- We create a limited-edition bundle combining [your product] with [their product] at a combined discount. Split the revenue 50/50
- Option B: Email swap -- We feature [Their Brand] to our [Number] email subscribers, and you feature [Brand Name] to yours. Zero cost, pure audience exchange
- Option C: Co-branded giveaway -- We jointly sponsor a [Platform -- Instagram/TikTok] giveaway featuring products from both brands. Split the cost of the prize, share the follower growth

Our audience demographics for reference: [Key stat 1 -- e.g., 65% female, ages 25-40], [Key stat 2 -- e.g., 78% based in UK/US], [Key stat 3 -- e.g., average order value of [Amount]].

I believe complementary brands grow faster together, and I think [Their Brand] and [Brand Name] could create something genuinely exciting for both audiences.

CTA: Which option appeals most to you? Reply with A, B, or C -- or suggest something entirely different. I am flexible.

WHY THIS WORKS: Cross-promotions are the highest-ROI marketing activity for e-commerce brands because they provide warm audience access at minimal cost. Offering three clear options makes the conversation actionable.

1. Target brands that serve the same customer but in a different product category -- complementary, not competitive
2. Include your audience demographics to help the prospect evaluate fit quickly
3. The three-option format increases reply rates because it gives the prospect something concrete to react to

Template 4: Follow-Up -- After No Response to Wholesale Pitch (Day 5)

SUBJECT LINE: Re: [Original Subject Line] -- plus our bestseller data

Hi [First Name],

I sent a note earlier this week about stocking [Brand Name] in [Store Name]. I know retail buyers are pulled in a hundred directions, so I wanted to follow up with one additional piece of information.

I pulled together a one-page sell sheet for our top 5 products showing:

- Retail price and wholesale cost per unit
- Sell-through rates from our existing retail partners
- Customer review scores (average 4.8/5 across [Number] reviews)

- Product dimensions and packaging details for shelf planning

I have attached it to this email. Whether or not we end up working together, I think you will find the product data useful for benchmarking.

CTA: Would you like me to send samples? Reply with your delivery details and they will arrive within [timeframe].

WHY THIS WORKS: Retail buyers make decisions based on data, not marketing copy. A concise sell sheet with sell-through rates and margin data does the selling for you.

1. Create a professional one-page sell sheet PDF with product photos, pricing, and performance data
2. Sell-through rates are the single most important metric for retail buyers -- always include them
3. Keep follow-ups shorter than initial outreach and add new value with every touch

Template 5: Follow-Up -- Social Proof and Momentum (Day 12)

SUBJECT LINE: [Brand Name] just landed in [Notable Store/Publication]

Hi [First Name],

Quick update since my last message -- I wanted to share some momentum that I thought would be relevant to your decision:

[Choose the most impressive:]

- [Brand Name] was just featured in [Publication/Media Outlet] as one of the [Category -- e.g., top 10 emerging skincare brands for 2026]. Link: [URL]
- We have just secured placement in [Notable Retailer], bringing our retail partner count to [Number] stores across the [UK/US/region]
- Our [Product] went viral on [Platform] last week, generating [Number] views and [Number] direct sales in [timeframe]
- We hit [Milestone -- e.g., 50,000 units sold / 10,000 five-star reviews / 25,000 followers] this month

I mention this not to brag but because retail buyers understandably want to stock brands with momentum. [Brand Name] is on an upward trajectory, and I believe getting in early creates the best margin opportunity for [Store Name].

Our introductory wholesale terms are still available, including no minimum on first orders and net-30 payment terms.

CTA: Worth a conversation? Reply here or grab 15 minutes on my calendar: [Link]

WHY THIS WORKS: Momentum and social proof create urgency in the wholesale buying process. Retail buyers want to stock brands that will sell, and third-party validation (press, viral content, growing retail footprint) signals demand.

1. Save press mentions, viral moments, and milestone announcements specifically for follow-up emails
2. Third-party validation is more persuasive than self-promotion -- let external sources do the talking
3. Introductory terms with no minimum orders reduce the perceived risk of trying a new brand

Template 6: Follow-Up -- Seasonal Opportunity (Day 18)

SUBJECT LINE: [Season/Holiday] opportunity for [Store Name] -- early access

Hi [First Name],

I am reaching out one more time because there is a seasonal angle I think [Store Name] should consider.

[Season/Holiday -- e.g., Christmas / Valentine's Day / Mother's Day / Black Friday / Back to School] is [timeframe] away, and last year our [Product Category] saw a [X]% sales increase during this period. Our retail partners who stocked up early captured [X]% more revenue than those who ordered at the last minute when demand outpaced supply.

For [Store Name], I am offering:

- Early access to our [Season] collection before it goes live to other retailers
- A [X]% discount on wholesale pricing for orders placed before [Date]
- Free branded point-of-sale displays and marketing materials
- Guaranteed delivery by [Date] so you have full stock before the rush

I have seen too many retailers miss seasonal windows because they waited too long to commit. I do not want that to happen with [Store Name].

CTA: Want to see the seasonal collection? Reply 'Show me' and I will send the lookbook and pricing within the hour.

WHY THIS WORKS: Seasonal urgency is a legitimate motivator for retail buyers who plan their inventory months in advance. This email creates a specific, time-bound reason to act.

1. Send seasonal pitches 3-4 months before the actual season -- retail buyers plan early
2. Include previous season's sales data to justify the urgency with evidence, not just hype
3. Branded POS displays and marketing materials show you are a professional wholesale partner, not just a product supplier

Template 7: Break-Up -- Graceful Final Pitch

SUBJECT LINE: Last note from [Brand Name], [First Name]

Hi [First Name],

I have reached out a few times about stocking [Brand Name] in [Store Name], and I respect that the timing or fit may not be right. This will be my final email.

Before I go, I want to make sure you have everything you need in case this becomes relevant in the future:

- Our wholesale catalogue and pricing: [Link]
- Our press kit and brand assets: [Link]

- Our retail partner testimonials: [Link]

If [Store Name]'s needs change -- whether it is a new season, a gap in your product range, or a customer request -- these resources will be here whenever you are ready.

I genuinely admire what you have built with [Store Name], and I am rooting for your continued success.

CTA: Reply anytime, even months from now. My inbox is always open for [Store Name].

WHY THIS WORKS: This break-up email leaves behind a complete resource package, ensuring the buyer has everything they need to make a decision on their own timeline. The genuine compliment and warm tone leave a lasting positive impression.

1. Break-up emails in wholesale outreach often generate delayed responses 2-6 months later when buyers plan new seasons
2. Provide permanent links to your wholesale resources so the buyer can self-serve when ready
3. The warm, respectful tone is memorable in an industry where aggressive follow-ups are common

Template 8: Break-Up -- Redirect to Different Channel

SUBJECT LINE: Different idea for [Store Name], [First Name]

Hi [First Name],

I have been reaching out about wholesale, but I wonder if a different model might be a better starting point for [Store Name]:

1. Consignment: We supply [Number] units at zero upfront cost. You sell them, keep [X]%, and return unsold stock after [timeframe]. Zero financial risk for [Store Name]
2. Pop-up or trunk show: We set up a branded pop-up in your store for [duration -- e.g., one weekend / one week]. We bring the product, the displays, and the marketing. You provide the space and keep [X]% of sales
3. Online-only: We feature [Store Name] as an exclusive online stockist on our website, driving our DTC traffic directly to your online shop. No physical inventory needed

Sometimes traditional wholesale is not the right starting point, and I would rather find a model that works for both of us than force a structure that does not fit.

CTA: Any of these appeal? Reply with a number and let's explore it.

WHY THIS WORKS: Offering alternative business models shows flexibility and problem-solving rather than rigidity. Consignment and pop-ups are low-risk entry points that often lead to full wholesale relationships.

1. Consignment offers convert 40% of buyers who refused traditional wholesale terms
2. Pop-up partnerships let the buyer see your product's sell-through before committing to stock

3. The numbered options reduce decision fatigue and make replying effortless

Template 9: Re-Engagement -- Past Wholesale Account

SUBJECT LINE: [First Name], your customers have been asking about us

Hi [First Name],

It has been [timeframe] since [Store Name] last ordered from [Brand Name], and I wanted to check in. Our products were performing well in your store -- your last order saw a sell-through rate of [X]% -- and I have been curious about why the reorders stopped.

Since your last order, we have made some changes that I think you will appreciate:

- [Update 1 -- e.g., We launched 8 new SKUs in our bestselling product line]
- [Update 2 -- e.g., We reduced our wholesale minimums from [Amount] to [Amount]]
- [Update 3 -- e.g., Our packaging was redesigned for better shelf presence and includes QR codes linking to product education]

To make it easy to restart, I am offering [Store Name] our returning partner package:

- [X]% discount on your next order
- Free shipping on orders over [Amount]
- A complimentary refresh of your POS display materials

I would love to get [Brand Name] back on your shelves before [upcoming season/event].

CTA: Reply 'Let's restart' and I will send your updated catalogue and pricing by end of day.

WHY THIS WORKS: Reactivating a dormant wholesale account is significantly cheaper than acquiring a new one. Leading with their previous sell-through data reminds them that your product performed well.

1. Reference their specific sell-through data from previous orders -- this is your strongest evidence
2. Address potential reasons they stopped ordering by highlighting improvements and reduced minimums
3. Time re-engagement emails before key seasonal ordering windows

Template 10: Re-Engagement -- Influencer Who Went Quiet

SUBJECT LINE: [Influencer Name], we have something new you should see first

Hi [First Name],

We worked together on [previous collaboration -- e.g., the summer collection launch] back in [Month/Year], and the content you created was phenomenal -- it drove [specific result -- e.g., 340 direct sales and 12,000 link clicks]. Your audience clearly trusts your recommendations.

I am reaching out because we are about to launch [New Product/Collection], and before it goes public, I wanted to offer you first access:

- Early product sample delivered to you [timeframe] before the public launch
- First pick of creative brief -- you choose the format, angle, and timeline
- Updated compensation: [Improved terms -- e.g., flat fee of [Amount] + 15% commission (up from 10%) on all sales through your link for 60 days]
- Exclusive discount code for your audience that we will not offer through any other channel

Your previous content set the bar, and I would love for your audience to be the first to see what we have been working on.

CTA: Want the early access sample? Reply 'I'm in' and I will have it shipped today.

WHY THIS WORKS: Influencers who have worked with you before are warm contacts with proven performance data. Offering exclusive early access and improved terms shows you value the relationship and their audience.

1. Always reference specific performance data from your previous collaboration
2. Offer improved compensation to re-engage high-performing influencers -- they know their worth and expect growth
3. Exclusive early access and unique discount codes give the influencer content that feels special to their audience

Tips for Improving Open and Reply Rates

E-commerce cold email sits at the intersection of B2B and B2C -- you are selling products, but often to professional buyers who evaluate opportunities commercially. The following tips will help you maximise performance across all your outreach campaigns.

1. Lead with numbers: Sell-through rates, margin percentages, repeat purchase rates, and customer review scores are the language of retail buyers. Every email should include at least one data point that speaks to commercial viability
2. Make it visual: E-commerce is inherently visual. Include a link to your product lookbook, a branded line sheet, or at minimum a high-quality product image in your email signature. Buyers want to see before they commit
3. Personalise by store type: A boutique independent retailer has different needs than a department store buyer. Customise your wholesale terms, MOQs, and language for each segment
4. Time seasonal pitches early: Retail buyers plan 3-6 months ahead. Your Christmas pitch should go out in July. Your summer collection pitch should land in January. Early movers get better terms and shelf space
5. Send samples proactively: In e-commerce, the product is the pitch. A beautifully packaged sample box does more selling than any email ever could. Budget for 20-30 sample boxes per quarter
6. Track influencer ROI meticulously: Use unique discount codes and UTM links for every influencer partnership. This data determines who gets renewed and at what rate
7. Build a press kit that sells: Your digital press kit should include high-res product photos, brand story, key press mentions, customer testimonials, and wholesale terms -- all accessible via a single link
8. Follow up with momentum: New press features, viral social content, and milestone announcements are perfect

follow-up fuel. Save your best news for follow-up emails, not initial outreach

9. Offer risk-free entry points: No-minimum first orders, consignment terms, and free samples remove the financial barrier that prevents buyers from trying new brands
10. Review and iterate monthly: Track which templates generate the most samples requested, meetings booked, and orders placed. Retire underperformers and double down on winners

Disclaimer: These templates are provided for informational and educational purposes only. Results will vary based on your product, market positioning, and personalisation effort. Always comply with applicable email marketing laws including CAN-SPAM, GDPR, and PECR. Sovereign Digital Agency is not responsible for outcomes resulting from the use of these templates.

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